

Phase 5: Distribution Channels

Document type: founder-led distribution operating guide.

Status: internal working document. Use for controlled distribution experiments only. Review customer-facing claims with founder, product, security, and counsel before publishing broadly.

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Required boundary: GCCS is a No-CUI / compliance management MVP. Distribution messages must not claim legal advice, accounting advice, labor determinations, CMMC certification, assessor determinations, contracting-officer determinations, government endorsement, formal assessment outcomes, or permission to upload real CUI.

Phase Goal

Create a repeatable path to qualified pilot conversations without buying broad traffic too early.

The goal is not brand awareness. The goal is qualified distribution: repeatable sources of small GovCon prospects or advisors who understand the readiness workflow pain, accept the No-CUI pilot boundary, and can move toward a paid guided pilot.

Critique And Failure Risks

- Paid ads too early will likely fail because the buyer message, objection handling, and winning niche are still being validated.
- Treating distribution as "post everywhere" creates noise but not pipeline. Each channel needs a measurable call-to-action.
- APEX counselors, advisors, and associations may educate or introduce, but they generally should not be treated as private-product endorsers.
- SAM.gov can identify niches, agencies, NAICS patterns, set-asides, and award activity, but using it to spam buyers is a reputational and compliance risk.
- LinkedIn authority content without direct outbound will be too slow for first-customer traction.

Correct Channel Priority

Prioritize channels in this order:

Priority	Channel	Primary objective	When to use
1	Direct founder-led outbound to small contractors	Book qualified discovery, demo, and pilot calls.	Immediately after Phase 3 signal and Phase 4 pilot offer are ready.
2	Partnerships with APEX counselors and GovCon advisors	Earn trusted introductions and validate education topics.	After you can clearly explain the No-CUI pilot boundary.
3	MSP/compliance consultant referral partnerships	Build advisor-led referral pipeline.	After you know which advisor pain GCCS reduces.
4	LinkedIn authority content	Create visible proof of expertise and warm up outbound.	Run in parallel with direct outbound.
5	Webinars with practical topics	Convert education demand into discovery and pilot calls.	After at least one painful workflow is repeatedly validated.
6	GovCon newsletters/podcasts	Borrow audience trust and test founder narrative.	After the offer and pilot story are clear.
7	Paid search, directories, marketplaces	Scale validated demand.	Only after manual channels produce repeatable paid-pilot signals.

Distribution Offer

Every distribution channel should point to one of these actions:

- 1. Book a 20-minute workflow discovery call.
- 2. Book a 30-minute No-CUI demo.
- 3. Apply for the 30-day guided readiness pilot.
- 4. Attend a practical readiness workflow session.
- 5. Request the sample readiness workflow or sample report.

Do not drive early traffic to a broad "start subscription" call-to-action. The first offer is still a managed pilot.

Channel 1: Direct Founder-Led Outbound To Small Contractors

Purpose

Direct outbound is the fastest way to learn which niche, pain statement, and pilot offer converts.

Target Buyers

- Small government contractor founders.
- Subcontractor founders.
- Operations leads.
- Contracts managers.
- Security or compliance leads at small contractors.
- 8(a), SDVOSB, WOSB, HUBZone, and other small-business contractors where readiness tracking is operationally painful.

Targeting Sources

Source	Use
Phase 3 discovery notes	Identify the niche and pain language that repeated most often.
LinkedIn search	Find founders, operations leads, contracts leads, security leads, and advisors.
Company websites	Confirm size, services, agency focus, and contact paths.
SAM.gov Contracting	Research opportunities, awards, subcontract reports, agencies, NAICS, set-asides, and market patterns.
USAspending	Research award patterns and common customer agencies.
SBA Small Business Search	Identify certified small-business categories and public company profiles.
GSA eLibrary	Research schedule holders and categories.

SAM.gov Research Rules

SAM.gov is useful for market research because it centralizes contract opportunities, awards, subcontract reports, and contracting data.

Use SAM.gov to:

- Identify agencies buying from small contractors.
- Identify NAICS codes with active opportunities.
- Identify set-aside categories relevant to small contractors.

- Identify recurring compliance-heavy contract types.
- Identify prime/subcontracting patterns.
- Understand which niches may have readiness pressure.

Do not use SAM.gov to:

- Spam vendors.
- Copy sensitive data into GCCS.
- Treat public award data as permission to contact aggressively.
- Claim government endorsement.
- Build automated outreach lists without reviewing terms, privacy, and reputational risk.

Recommended Outbound Volume

Week	Action
Week 1	Build 100-account target list from one niche. Send 30 highly manual messages.
Week 2	Send 40 more messages. Follow up with Week 1 non-responders. Book 5 discovery/demo calls.
Week 3	Send 50 more messages. Test one new pain statement. Book 5-7 calls.
Week 4	Stop weak messaging. Double down on the niche and subject line that produces qualified calls.

Direct Outbound Message

Subject: Quick question on readiness tracking

Hi <Name>,

I am speaking with small government contractors about how they track contract readiness tasks, source-backed obligations, evidence metadata, owners, and proof requests.

I am not asking for contract documents, CUI, or sensitive data. GCCS is currently a No-CUI compliance-management MVP.

The pattern I am testing is whether teams are still managing readiness through spreadsheets, email, and shared folders.

Would you be open to a 20-minute workflow call? I am trying to understand what breaks first and whether a narrow guided pilot would be useful.

Thank you, <Your Name>

Follow-Up Message

Hi <Name>,

Following up once. The specific question is:

When someone asks for proof of readiness, obligations, evidence, or task ownership, where does your current tracker break first?

If this is not your area, who owns contract or compliance readiness internally?

Thank you, <Your Name>

Direct Outbound Metrics

Track these weekly:

Metric	Healthy early benchmark
Manual messages sent	30-50 per week
Reply rate	8%-15%
Qualified call rate	3%-8% of messages
Demo conversion from call	25%-40%
Pilot proposal conversion from demo	20%-30%
Paid pilot close	1 from first 50-150 qualified outbound contacts

Channel 2: Partnerships With APEX Counselors And GovCon Advisors

Purpose

APEX counselors and GovCon advisors can help you understand market pain, identify education topics, and earn warm introductions. They should not be asked to endorse GCCS improperly.

Partner Targets

- Local APEX Accelerator counselors.
- SBA resource partners.
- GovCon advisors.
- PTAC/APEX-style regional training organizations.
- Contracting-readiness trainers.
- Small-business procurement instructors.

Partnership Ask

Do not ask: "Will you promote my SaaS?"

Ask:

- What readiness workflow do your clients struggle with after registration?
- Would a No-CUI readiness tracking worksheet or webinar be useful?
- Would you review a practical training outline?
- Are there contractors who volunteered to discuss workflow pain?
- Can I provide a non-promotional session on readiness tracking mistakes?

APEX/GovCon Advisor Message

Subject: Practical readiness workflow session for small contractors

Hi <Name>,

I am building GCCS, a No-CUI compliance-management workflow tool for small government contractors. I am not asking for an endorsement.

I am trying to create practical education around how small contractors track readiness tasks, obligations, evidence metadata, owners, and proof requests without using a SaaS product as a CUI repository.

Would a short educational session or worksheet on "the readiness spreadsheet that breaks first" be useful for your audience?

Thank you, <Your Name>

Partner Output

Each partner conversation should produce one of these:

- Education topic feedback.
- A warm introduction.
- A webinar opportunity.
- An invitation to office hours or local event.
- A clear no-fit reason.

Channel 3: MSP And Compliance Consultant Referral Partnerships

Purpose

MSPs and compliance consultants see the recurring operational burden after initial advisory or technical setup. GCCS can become a workflow layer they refer into when clients need task ownership, evidence metadata, and report artifacts.

Best-Fit Referral Partners

- MSPs supporting DoD contractors.
- CMMC consultants.
- NIST 800-171 consultants.
- Fractional compliance leads.
- Virtual CISO providers serving small GovCons.
- GovCon operations consultants.

Partner Qualification

Requirement	Why it matters
Serves small GovCon clients	Keeps distribution aligned with the ICP.
Sees repeated evidence/task tracking pain	Ensures GCCS reduces real advisor burden.
Accepts No-CUI MVP posture	Prevents unsafe referrals.
Understands GCCS is not a certifier	Prevents false claims.
Can refer one specific client workflow	Keeps the first referral concrete.

Referral Partner Offer

Start simple:

- No referral fee until counsel reviews partner terms.
- Offer co-branded education first.
- Offer a guided demo for one client.
- Offer advisor feedback access during the pilot.
- Track partner-sourced calls and pilots manually.

Do not launch a formal partner program until at least 3 advisor referrals have produced qualified calls.

MSP/Consultant Message

Subject: Reducing client follow-through burden after readiness work

Hi <Name>,

I am researching whether GCCS can help small GovCon teams keep track of readiness tasks, source-backed obligations, evidence metadata, owners, and report artifacts after advisor or MSP work begins.

The MVP is No-CUI only and does not provide legal advice, certification, or formal assessment determinations.

Would you be open to a 20-minute conversation about where clients lose follow-through after policies, technical setup, or readiness planning?

Thank you, <Your Name>

Channel 4: LinkedIn Authority Content

Purpose

LinkedIn should warm up trust and support outbound. It should not replace founder-led outreach.

Content Pillars

Pillar	Example topics
Readiness workflow pain	"The spreadsheet that breaks first for small GovCons."
Evidence metadata	"Evidence is not useful if no one owns it."
No-CUI operating boundary	"Why a No-CUI pilot can still validate readiness workflow pain."
Source-backed obligations	"Do not track compliance tasks without source context."
Pilot lessons	"What we are learning from 20 workflow conversations."
Advisor workflow	"Why MSPs and consultants get stuck chasing client follow-through."

Weekly LinkedIn Cadence

Day	Post type
Monday	Practical lesson from discovery.
Wednesday	Workflow breakdown or checklist.
Friday	Short founder note or pilot-learning post.

LinkedIn Content Rules

- Do not claim certification outcomes.
- Do not imply government endorsement.
- Do not mention customer names without permission.
- Do not discuss sensitive customer data.
- Use anonymized workflow lessons only when permission exists.
- End with a specific question or soft call-to-action.

Example LinkedIn Post

Small GovCon teams do not usually lose compliance work because they lack another document.

They lose it because ownership, evidence metadata, source context, and report readiness live in different places.

The question I am asking in discovery:

When someone asks for proof, which tracker breaks first?

GCCS is testing a No-CUI guided readiness pilot around one workflow: obligations, owners, evidence metadata, and one report artifact.

If you support small contractors, what breaks first in your clients' process?

Channel 5: Webinars With Practical Topics

Purpose

Webinars should convert repeated workflow pain into qualified discovery calls. They should be practical and narrow, not broad thought leadership.

Recommended Webinar Topics

Topic	Target audience	CTA
The readiness spreadsheet that breaks first	Small GovCon founders/operators	Book a workflow review.
How to track obligations without storing CUI	Security leads, contracts leads, advisors	Request No-CUI demo.
Evidence metadata for small contractors	MSPs, compliance consultants, contractors	Apply for guided pilot.
From contract clause to owner and proof	Contracts managers, proposal consultants	Request sample workflow.
What primes ask subcontractors to prove	Subcontractors and advisors	Book discovery call.

Webinar Structure

Time	Segment
0-5 min	No-CUI and no-certification boundary.
5-15 min	Explain the workflow problem.
15-30 min	Walk through a practical checklist or sample workflow.
30-40 min	Show a synthetic GCCS workflow only if appropriate.
40-50 min	Q&A without collecting sensitive details.
50-60 min	Invite qualified attendees to a workflow review or pilot call.

Webinar Follow-Up

Send attendees:

- No-CUI policy link.
- Sample obligation/evidence workflow.
- Sample readiness report.
- Guided pilot description.
- Booking link for workflow review.

Channel 6: GovCon Newsletters And Podcasts

Purpose

Newsletters and podcasts borrow trust from existing audiences. They are useful after the offer and story are clear enough to survive public questioning.

Target Shows And Publications

Prioritize:

- Small-business federal contracting newsletters.
- CMMC and NIST 800-171 advisor newsletters.
- GovCon founder podcasts.
- Proposal/capture communities.
- Veteran-owned, woman-owned, 8(a), HUBZone, and small-business communities.
- MSP/cybersecurity newsletters serving DoD contractors.

Pitch Angle

Do not pitch "new SaaS launch."

Pitch practical market learning:

- Why small contractors lose readiness evidence.
- Why No-CUI workflow pilots are safer than pretending every SaaS is ready for sensitive data.
- What 20 discovery conversations revealed about GovCon compliance spreadsheets.
- How advisors can reduce follow-through burden without becoming the customer's project manager.

Podcast/Newsletter Pitch

Subject: Practical topic for small GovCon readiness tracking

Hi <Name>,

I am the founder of GCCS, a No-CUI compliance-management workflow tool for small government contractors.

I am not looking to pitch certification claims. A practical topic for your audience may be:

"The readiness spreadsheet that breaks first: how small contractors lose track of obligations, evidence metadata, owners, and proof requests."

The discussion can stay educational and avoid sensitive data, legal advice, certification claims, or customer-specific details.

Would this be useful for your audience?

Thank you, <Your Name>

Channel 7: Paid Search, Directories, And Marketplaces

Use Later Only

Delay these until manual channels prove:

- Which niche responds.
- Which pain statement converts.
- Which landing page message works.
- Which demo produces pilot intent.
- Which objections block conversion.
- Which price range is credible.

When Paid Channels Become Appropriate

Use paid channels only when:

- At least 2 paid pilots have closed.

- At least 1 pilot converts or strongly validates subscription intent.
- A landing page is reviewed for claims and No-CUI boundaries.
- Counsel has reviewed public terms, disclaimers, and pricing language.
- You can track source, conversion, and customer acquisition cost.

Paid Channel Risks

- "CMMC software" keywords may attract buyers expecting certification or CUI handling.
- Marketplaces may imply stronger trust posture than the MVP currently supports.
- Directories can create low-intent demos if the CTA is too broad.
- Paid traffic can pressure you into overclaiming security or compliance capabilities.

90-Day Distribution Plan

Period	Focus	Required output
Days 1-15	Direct outbound sprint	100 targets, 50 messages, 5 calls, 2 demos.
Days 16-30	Partner discovery	10 APEX/advisor conversations, 5 partner follow-ups, 1 webinar topic selected.
Days 31-45	MSP/compliance referral testing	20 partner targets, 5 calls, 2 client referral opportunities.
Days 46-60	LinkedIn authority cadence	9 posts, 3 validated content themes, 3 inbound conversations.
Days 61-75	First practical webinar	1 webinar, 20 registrants, 5 workflow review calls.
Days 76-90	Newsletter/podcast outreach	20 pitches, 3 accepted conversations or placements.

Distribution Metrics

Track every channel in phase-5-distribution-channel-tracker.csv (./phase-5-distribution-channel-tracker.csv).

Metric	Definition
Target accounts	Number of researched accounts or partner targets.
Messages sent	Manual outbound messages, not automated impressions.
Replies	Human replies.
Qualified conversations	Calls with ICP fit, workflow pain, and No-CUI fit.
Demos booked	Product demos booked from the channel.
Pilot proposals	Written pilot scopes sent.
Paid pilots	Paid or signed guided pilots.
Conversion source	The channel that created the first meaningful contact.
Disqualification reason	No-CUI mismatch, no budget, no owner, certification expectation, enterprise requirement, no pain.

Channel Decision Rules

Signal	Action
Direct outbound books qualified calls	Keep direct outbound as primary channel and refine niche.
APEX/advisors engage but cannot refer	Use them for education topics, not sales expectations.

Signal	Action
MSPs refer clients with no buyer authority	Add buyer-confirmation step before demo.
LinkedIn gets likes but no calls	Tighten CTA and pair posts with direct outreach.
Webinars draw advisors but not contractors	Create advisor referral motion or change topic.
Newsletters/podcasts create unqualified interest	Use stricter No-CUI and pilot-fit language.
Paid search looks tempting before pilots close	Delay. Manual distribution has not produced enough signal.

Required Sales Assets By Channel

Channel	Required asset
Direct outbound	One-page offer, discovery call script, Phase 4 pilot guide.
APEX/advisors	No-CUI policy, sample workflow, educational webinar outline.
MSP/compliance consultants	Security/data-handling page, sample readiness report, partner call script.
LinkedIn	Positioning messages, anonymized lessons, sample workflow visuals where approved.
Webinars	Practical checklist, demo script, No-CUI boundary slide, booking CTA.
Newsletters/podcasts	Founder story, practical topic pitch, claims-safe product description.
Paid channels	Reviewed landing page, reviewed pricing page, tracking, counsel-approved terms.

Exit Criteria

Phase 5 is complete when:

- At least 3 channels have been tested with tracked activity.
- Direct outbound has produced at least 5 qualified conversations.
- At least 1 advisor, APEX, MSP, consultant, newsletter, or webinar channel has produced a qualified referral or audience opportunity.
- At least 1 channel has produced a pilot proposal.
- Channel performance is recorded in the tracker.
- A decision is made about which 1-2 channels to continue for Phase 6.
- Paid search, directories, and marketplaces remain deferred unless manual channels have produced paid-pilot evidence.

Hidden Risks

- A channel can look promising because people are polite. Only qualified calls, pilot proposals, and paid pilots count as serious signal.
- Advisor referrals can produce non-buyers if the end customer has no budget, owner, or No-CUI fit.
- Public content can accidentally imply legal, assessment, or certification authority. Keep disclaimers in every educational asset.
- SAM.gov research can bias targeting toward visible awardees while missing subcontractors and smaller firms not actively visible in public data.
- Webinars can create a support burden if attendees ask customer-specific compliance questions. Keep Q&A educational and non-sensitive.
- Referral economics, testimonials, and co-marketing require counsel review before formal use.

Source Notes

- SAM.gov Contracting states it is a centralized source for finding and bidding on U.S. government contract opportunities, awards, and publishing subcontract reports. It also points users to contract data downloads, APIs, opportunity search, award data, subcontract reports, NAICS, set-asides, and location filters: SAM.gov Contracting (<https://sam.gov/contracting>).
- Phase 5 should continue using the Phase 3 source directories and partner categories for APEX, SBA, MSP, compliance consultant, accounting, proposal consultant, and small-prime/subcontractor discovery.

Related Documents

- Phase 1: Lock The Offer (./phase-1-lock-the-offer.md)
- Phase 2 Sales Assets Index (./phase-2-sales-assets-index.md)
- Phase 3: Validate With 20 Conversations (./phase-3-validate-with-20-conversations.md)
- Phase 4: Create A Pilot Offer (./phase-4-create-a-pilot-offer.md)
- One-Page Offer (./phase-1-one-page-offer.md)
- Discovery Call Script (./phase-1-discovery-call-script.md)
- No-CUI Policy Statement (./no-cui-policy-statement.md)
- Security And Data-Handling Page (./security-and-data-handling-page.md)
- Pricing Page With Founder-Friendly Pilot Option (./pricing-page-founder-pilot.md)